



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Boys' Latin of Philadelphia

School Website: <http://boyslatin.org>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Boys' Latin of Philadelphia presents a public charter school that leans toward classical education in its stated foundation (notably a Latin-language emphasis) while integrating robust contemporary practices (1:1 technology, extended learning time, and college-advising programs). Based on a rubric drawn from the classical-school knowledge base, the school exhibits several core classical elements—most clearly in its Latin-centric curriculum and in character formation and aspirational language around virtue and leadership—but it does not consistently manifest all six elements at the level typical of a thoroughly Classical model (e.g., explicit Great Books, explicit Scholé/restful pedagogy, or a fully articulated Great Conversation). The aggregate assessment, therefore, places Boys' Latin in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range, with pronounced Classical affinities in Curriculum and Pedagogy, plus notable strengths in Family/Community engagement, while Religious and Metaphysical Foundations appear less explicit in public-facing materials.

Key supporting observations: - Foundational classical orientation is explicit in mission language emphasizing "a classical Latin education" and a culture of critical thinking, personal responsibility, and character development. - The public-facing site highlights a number of classically inflected elements (Latin language requirement, daily Latin classes, a "living" character-education frame, advisory/seminar structures, and leadership development) alongside contemporary practices (1:1 devices, extended day, and a broad array of extracurriculars). - The school clearly foregrounds partnership with families and a shared mission to prepare students for college and leadership, signaling strong Parents & Community alignment, albeit without a fully spelled-out parent-formation program in the public materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Notes on the six-category rubric: - The school's public-facing materials emphasize formation, virtue (via character education and honor-related practices), and leadership development, along with a Latin-centric curriculum and seminar-like elements. However, explicit references to theology, liturgy, or liturgical/community worship are not evident in the available public content, so Element 1 lands at Not Classical based on the presence/absence of those explicit metaphysical foundations. The remaining five categories show meaningful classical alignment (e.g., Latin language emphasis, Great Books/Great Conversation signals are not explicit, but the overall formation/paideia-like thrust is present via mission, seminars, and leadership programs), yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL assessment for those groups. - Evidence drawn from the public-facing site content (Mission & Vision; The BL Experience; Departments; Outside Opportunities;

College Advising) and from the classical-school keyword framework in the Six Essential Elements (Positive/Negative Keywords) lexicon.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rankings) - Expand explicit Great Books/Great Conversation elements (public-facing language and course listings) and document a more explicit Great Books program or canonical-reading sequence. - Make explicit the pedagogical elements of Scholé and contemplative/restful learning in lower and upper grades, with public-facing language about quiet reflection or “restful curriculum” days. - Strengthen explicit “portrait of a teacher” and “living curriculum” language in external communications (public pages) to align more tightly with classical-faculty concepts. - Deepen parental formation offerings via book studies, lectures, and family liturgies, and communicate these publicly as ongoing co-education with families.

What would move the needle (Concrete, school-wide actions) - Add a formal Great Books/GW sequence to core humanities and history courses, with public-facing syllabi and reading lists. - Include explicit Scholé language in mission/policy pages (e.g., rest/restful days, contemplative pedagogy, and memory-work traditions) to strengthen Pedagogy alignment. - Publish a “Portrait of a Graduate” that foregrounds classical virtues in practice (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, eloquence) and tie it to teacher practice and assessment. - Expand Parent Formation programming publicly (book clubs, lectures, family liturgy) and publish a year-long schedule of parent-partner activities.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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